13D data idea: a five-minute conversation

Speaking guide | 13 October 2026 | Explain for 3 minutes; invite feedback for 2

0:00-0:35 | The idea

I am building a machine learning class project around 13D filings. The question is whether information about who is investing, their ownership and their stated plans can help select stocks after disclosure. I want to test a potential source of alpha, rather than assume that following an activist creates an edge.

0:35-1:15 | What I have done

I have a source-audited archive of about 75,600 filing records and have processed about 15,800 initial-filing candidates for factual extraction. Separately, the current return-data and feature checks leave 667 initial-event candidates. I have built ten structured inputs and prepared chronological training data. No predictive model has been trained, and the earlier simple-following work has not established a reliable edge.

1:15-1:50 | How I identify investors

I use 35 historical HFR snapshots to find candidate manager matches and distinguish activist, other Event-Driven and other strategies. I am concerned that a firm's strategy label does not necessarily describe a particular filing, and legal vehicles complicate identity. Most current observations remain other or unresolved; I am keeping them in scope.

1:50-2:25 | How filings become observations

My current row represents an eligible initial disclosure linked to a stock and a subsequent return window. The existing cuts include market-data coverage, prior investor-company history and overlapping positions. I want your view on which cuts are appropriate for learning a signal. Amendments may provide additional information, but they cannot be counted as independent new investments or used before they became public.

2:25-3:00 | Where I go next

First I will train a small neural network and simpler comparisons using rule-based facts. Then I will test whether validated LLM extraction of ownership relationships and stated intentions adds information. BlackRock publicly describes LLM-based investment text analysis, and specialist 13D research already exists. I would like to understand where you think a student project could make a useful contribution.

3:00-5:00 | Ask, then pause

Would you change the HFR investor definition or the way I construct observations, and where would you look for information the market may not already price in?

Follow only the thread he picks; use these prompts if needed:

Investor definition: HFR categories, validated manager identities, or intent in each filing?

Observation design: retain a broader initial-event panel, with amendments as separately timed updates?

Industry practice: which extraction or signal questions would make this a useful, realistic project?

The two-page handout contains the sample cuts and public-source links. Leave it with him; do not read the sample table aloud. If interrupted, move directly to the main question.

Remember: an observation is one model row; inputs are facts available at that date; the target is the later return. Repeatable rule-based extraction can still be wrong. LLM output can vary, so repeatability and source accuracy need separate checks.